

HASHKAMA WEEKLY

פרשת תזריע-מצורע
ל' ניסן תשפ"ו
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By Reb Gemini חכמה ב-א תאמין?

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini:
Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Rabosai, imagine a Yid finally closes on a house after paying today's absolutely astronomical interest rates, and suddenly a strange green streak appears on the drywall. The Kohen, acting as the world's most devastating and entirely unbribable home inspector, arrives, takes one look, and orders the walls completely dismantled. To the exasperated homeowner, this looks like an absolute financial disaster. Yet, Rashi (Vayikra 14:34) brings down the famous Medrash that the Emori'im hid massive treasures inside their walls, meaning this devastating demolition is actually a highly lucrative excavation. The tzaraas habayis was never a punishment, but a very aggressive remodeling strategy to secure hidden wealth. We see a similarly profound, counterintuitive mechanism regarding the taharah process of the metzora himself. The Torah mandates bringing shtei tzipporim chayos tehoros for his purification (Vayikra 14:4). Rashi (Vayikra 14:4), quoting the Gemorah (Arachin 16b), famously explains that because the metzora engaged in Lashon Hara, constantly chattering and chirping away like a tiny bird, his taharah specifically requires birds. We slaughter one bird into an earthenware vessel and send the other away. The slaughtered bird represents completely killing off the negative, destructive babbling, while the living bird flying over the open field represents taking that exact same vocal energy and using it for higher, unconfined purposes. We can elegantly connect this physical dismantling process to our third topic this week, Shabbos Rosh Chodesh, which perfectly models this exact dynamic of breaking down to build up. The Gemorah (Sanhedrin 42a) discusses the beracha of Kiddush Levanah, praising the profound hischadshus of the moon. Think about the lunar cycle: the moon shrinks and shrinks until it completely disappears into utter darkness. To an uneducated observer who has never seen a Hebrew calendar, the moon looks completely destroyed, much like the metzora sitting badad completely outside the machaneh (Vayikra 13:46), or the homeowner staring sadly at his smashed living room. Yet, the absolute darkest moment of the month is not the permanent end of the levanah, but the exact split-second of its upcoming hischadshus. The total disappearance is merely the strict prerequisite for spectacular renewal. When the metzora sees his walls knocked down, or when he sits in complete isolation realizing his chirping caused utter destruction, he feels completely eclipsed. But Shabbos Rosh Chodesh firmly reminds us that this temporary darkness is exactly where the gold is found. The painful isolation cures the Lashon Hara, and the smashed drywall reveals the hidden treasure. The eclipse is just the brilliant setup for the tzippor to finally fly free. **Practical Takeaway:** The tachlis for us this week is to fundamentally change how we view the temporary demolitions in our own lives. When your grand plans completely fall apart, or when you feel isolated and pushed outside your usual machaneh, do not simply stand there mourning the lost drywall. Assume the role of the Kohen, look much closer, and start aggressively checking for the hidden gold that the Ribbono Shel Olam planted there specifically for you. Furthermore, strongly monitor your daily chattering. If you sound entirely like the tzippor gossiping by the herring at the Kiddush club, it is time to slaughter that habit. Channel that exact same vocal enthusiasm into deep divrei Torah and meaningful tefillah during davening. Embrace the hischadshus of the levanah, knowing that your darkest moments are just the precise starting line for your brightest renewal.

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Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

6:15/7:20 pm (Early/Late) הדלקה

מנחה - קבלת שבת pm

7:38 pm שקיעה

4:44/5:00 am (16.1/72) עלות השחר

6:12:15 am נץ החמה

7:15 am שחרית

Hot kiddush & Shiur after davening

8:58/9:34 am ס"ז קריאת שמע

10:17/10:41 am ס"ז תפילה

12:55:34 pm חצות היום

1:29:27 pm מנחה גדולה (30)

4:51:14 pm מנחה קטנה (גר"א)

6:15:18 pm פלג המנחה (גר"א)

מנחה pm

7:39 pm שקיעה

8:23/8:29 pm (8.5/50) צה"כ ר' משה

8:31 pm מעריב (52)

8:39/8:51 pm (60/72) צה"כ



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

6:20/7:27 pm (Early/Late) הדלקה

7:45 pm שקיעה

7:15 am שחרית

7:47 pm שקיעה

8:39 pm מעריב (52)

This Week's Riddle

Riddle: In this parsha, what inorganic object is described as being alive? What else is described as being alive?

Answer: The water used for the purification of the leper must be mayim chaim (Vayikra 14:5). b) as an offering, the leper must take what is described as "living birds" (Leviticus 14:4).



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משל ונמשל ב-AI תאמין? By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Mashal: Rabosai, imagine a highly typical, slightly tense scenario in any profoundly respected Litvish Bais Medrash. Reb Fishel, an exceedingly punctual and somewhat anxious balabos, recently acquires a state-of-the-art, satellite-synced, atomic-calibrated digital watch that tracks time down to the microscopic millisecond. One Friday afternoon, he furiously taps his expensive wrist, anxiously noting that shkiah is exactly thirty seconds away, yet the legendary Gabbai, Reb Berel, has not even begun to motion for the shaliach tzibbur to approach the bimah for Mincha. Reb Fishel, terrified about missing his chiyuv, scurries over to the Gabbai's heavily fortified shtender. He points frantically at his high-tech timepiece, breathlessly warning that the astronomical reality of the setting sun waits for absolutely no man. Reb Berel, possessing the glacial, terrifying calm of a man who has flawlessly controlled shul politics for four consecutive decades, slowly adjusts his reading glasses. He points a gnarled, authoritative finger at the cheap plastic shul clock hanging crookedly on the wall, and delivers a devastatingly dry response: "Reb Fishel, in this makom, the sun absolutely does not dare to set until I personally press the button to switch off the air conditioning." Reb Fishel shuffles back to his seat, thoroughly defeated but deeply enlightened, finally realizing that the United States Naval Observatory has absolutely zero jurisdiction here; the physical cosmos is entirely subservient to the earthly Gabbai. **Nimshal:** This exact phenomenon, where objective physical reality aggressively bends to the verbal decree of a human being, is the profound foundational link between Parshas Tazria-Metzora and our joyous celebration of Shabbos Rosh Chodesh. Regarding the metzora, the Torah explicitly dictates the terrifying, almost incomprehensible power of the Kohen. A person could wake up completely covered in a baheres the exact size of a gris, glowing as brilliantly white as the winter snow, visibly checking every single physiological box of tumah. Yet, the Mishnah (Nega'im 3:1) makes a spectacular, reality-altering ruling: until the Kohen explicitly utters the specific word "Tamei," this individual remains completely, undeniably tahor. The Gemorah (Makkos 22b) marvels at this incredible concept, noting that the biological disease itself does not manufacture the impurity; rather, the human articulation independently creates the reality. We observe this identical, mind-boggling mechanism regarding the sanctification of Rosh Chodesh. The Gemorah (Rosh Hashanah 25a) famously derives from the word "Atem" (Vayikra 23:4) that even if the Beis Din acts shogeg, mezid, or completely mutteh, their earthly declaration of the new month becomes the undisputed celestial reality. Heaven literally reschedules its entire Yom Tov itinerary because three Yidden in a small room decided to validate the nervous testimony of two farmers who might have just seen a particularly shiny cloud. The astronomical moon, much like Reb Fishel's fancy atomic watch, is completely irrelevant without the authoritative psak of the chachamim.

Practical Takeaway: The practical tachlis for us this week is to finally and fully internalize the utterly terrifying power of our own daily conversations. If the carefully spoken word of a Kohen single-handedly dictates the spiritual quarantine of a metzora, and the verbal decree of a Beis Din dictates the very fabric of time and the schedule of the malachim during Shabbos Rosh Chodesh, we must fiercely recognize what our casual comments do to the Yidden immediately surrounding us. We spend entirely too much of our precious time acting as self-appointed, entirely unpaid Kohanim, eagerly inspecting our fellow congregants for every minor chisaron. Instead of glaring at your chavrusah's incredibly weak sevarah and immediately declaring it intellectually tamei, or critiquing exactly how the shaliach tzibbur pronounces his cholem, utilize that exact same divine power of speech to construct a reality of taharah. Speak words of genuine chizuk to the bachur struggling to understand a complicated Tosafos, or the exhausted balabos merely trying to earn an honest parnassah. When you truly recognize that human speech literally writes the operating script for the physical and spiritual universe, you will hopefully stop using your supreme cosmic authority to complain to the Gabbai about the lack of potato kugel at the Kiddush, and start actively using it to bring absolute kedushah into the Bais Medrash.

GOOD SHABBUS!